

NAME

DATE

My family, my generations

Everybody in your house was your age once. Your job today is to find out what that was like, and to say it in English.

1 The timeline

Write the years next to each generation. Then write who in your family belongs there, with their age.

GENERATION

BORN

PEOPLE IN MY FAMILY

Generation Alpha

Generation Z

Millennials

Generation X

Baby Boomers

Start with yourself.

2 Six chunks

These words travel together. Learn them whole. Circle the three you can use about your own family.

digital native

global identity

virtual world

older generations

traditional culture

digital communication

REAL TALK

Chunk é bloco. **Digital native** não se traduz palavra por palavra e não se usa pela metade: ou vem inteiro, ou não vem. Guarde o bloco, não a palavra.

The interview

Ask three people at home, and your teacher, the same question. Then bring the answers back to class.

3 My question

Write one question about how people keep in touch. Ask everybody the same one.

How do you usually keep in touch with your friends or family?

4 The answers

Write what each person said. Short notes are fine, English only.

PERSON	GENERATION	WHAT THEY SAID
Me		

My teacher

5 Prove it

Saying it is not enough. Finish the sentence, then give the example that proves it.

- Older generations in my family _____.
For example, _____.
- I am a digital native, but _____.
For instance, _____.
- I spend time in a virtual world,
such as _____.

Four ways to ask

You are going to interview four people here at school. Same subject, four different questions. Build them before you leave this room.

BEFORE YOU ASK

Excuse me, could I ask you four questions for my English class?

and at the end: Thank you very much!

Never ask an adult how old they are. Ask about the time instead: when you were my age ...

1 DIRECT QUESTION

How often do you call people on the phone?

Question word, then **do**, then the person, then the verb.

MY VERSION

2 SUBJECT QUESTION

Who texts you the most?

When **who** is the subject, there is no **do**. Same order as a statement.

MY VERSION

Who

3 INDIRECT QUESTION

Could you tell me how you kept in touch with your friends when you were my age?

Polite. After the question phrase, the words go back to **statement order**.

MY VERSION

Do you know

4 TAG QUESTION

You didn't have a cell phone at school, did you?

You already think you know. Flip it: negative sentence, **positive tag**. The tag carries a pronoun.

MY VERSION

_____ , _____ ?

Ask first, then choose

One question opens the door. The answer tells you which panel to use. Then you ask four questions and write down what you hear.

1 The door

Ask everybody this, always first. Listen for one word.

When you were my age, how did you talk to your friends?

2 Find the panel

Match what they say. Then turn the page and use that panel.

PANEL	IF THEY SAY SOMETHING LIKE
A Generation Z a phone was always there	WhatsApp · Instagram · TikTok · "I always had a phone"
B Millennials the first screens	MSN · Orkut · Facebook · "my first phone was in high school"
C Generation X and before no screens at all	the landline · a letter · a note · "we just met in the street"

Nothing fits? Use panel B.

3 Same for everybody

These two never change, whatever the panel is.

1 · DIRECT QUESTION

How often do you call people on the phone?

2 · SUBJECT QUESTION

Who texts you the most?

REAL TALK

Repare que a pergunta da porta não pergunta idade. Ela pergunta uma lembrança, e a lembrança entrega a geração sozinha. Perguntar a idade de um adulto que você mal conhece fecha a conversa; perguntar como ele fazia quando tinha a sua idade abre.

4 The three panels

Use only your panel. Question 4 is your guess, so decide what you think before you say it.

A

Generation Z

3 · INDIRECT

Could you tell me how you and your friends decide where to meet?

4 · TAG

You've never used a landline, have you?

B

Millennials

3 · INDIRECT

Could you tell me what your first chat app was?

4 · TAG

You had MSN, didn't you?

C

Generation X and before

3 · INDIRECT

Could you tell me how you made plans with your friends before cell phones?

4 · TAG

You didn't have a cell phone at school, did you?

5 Four people

Circle the panel. In column 4, circle Y or N, then write what they actually said.

PERSON AND JOB	PANEL	1 · CALLS	2 · WHO TEXTS	3 · THEIR ANSWER	4 · RIGHT? WHAT THEY SAID
	A B C				Y N
	A B C				Y N
	A B C				Y N
	A B C				Y N